



The Leadership Challenge in Dawah Work

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Abstract ;

*This article aims to study the challenge of leadership in Dawah work as an essential requirement and a legal necessity regulating many issues and matters. It also seeks to uncover the significance of leadership, the main problems facing effective leadership, and the role that leadership plays in achieving the goals of Dawah work.
The research concludes that it is crucial to prepare effective leaders who possess a set of characteristics and skills, emphasizing the vital role of leadership in achieving the objectives of Dawah work. Leadership significantly impacts the success of Dawah efforts and the attainment of the desired goals and aspirations.*

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1. Introduction

Humans cannot live their entire lives randomly without organizing and prioritizing their interests and daily goals, whether at the family level or in their various interactions with individuals in the society they live in. Similarly, within societal interactions, there must be someone to manage their affairs, regulate their interactions, and inform them of their duties and rights, to uplift and maintain the community. This role is known as a president or leader, among other titles, all aiming to manage the affairs of people in organizations, communities, or nations.

Islam places great importance on the process of selecting a leader, giving it considerable attention and establishing essential principles and criteria that must be met for a leader to be qualified. The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) is the exemplary model for effective leadership application.

Contemporary Dawah work today faces numerous problems and challenges that hinder its success, especially with the rapid developments and changes in scientific, economic, political, and social aspects of public life. One of the significant issues is the neglect in the process of selecting effective leadership that achieves its goals and renews its methods, approaches, and techniques as required by current realities.

2. Problematic

This study is based on the main question: contemporary missionary work in need of leadership to achieve its goals?

It has three sub-questions:

- Does leadership indeed pose a challenge for Dawah work?
- What is the importance of leadership?

- What are the problems facing effective leadership?

3. Explanation of Key Research Terms (Challenge; Leadership; Dawah Work)

Before delving into the subject of the study, it is beneficial for the researcher to define the key terms of the study's title both linguistically and terminologically. This foundational understanding will guide the direction and approach of the study.

3.1 Definition of Challenge

Among what has been mentioned in dictionaries and lexicons regarding the word and its derivatives: he is a challenger, and the object is challenged. He challenged someone: He competed with and paralleled him. He challenged something: He faced it without fear (Ahmad Mukhtar, 2008, Vol. 1, p. 461).

There are several definitions for the term "challenges," but the definition we find most appropriate is: "Any change or transformation -quantitative or qualitative- that imposes specific requirements exceeding the capabilities of the society, necessitating it to face these challenges and take appropriate actions to address them" (Salem Muhammad, 1998, p. 177).

3.2 Definition of Leadership

He is a leader, and the object is led. Qada (to lead) a car or the like: He drove it, took charge of directing it. Qada (to lead) an army or the like: He headed it and managed its affairs (Ahmad Mukhtar, 2008, Vol. 3, p. 1868). "Many researchers have discussed leadership in general, and its definitions have varied depending on their perspectives. Mahmoud Salman defined it as: "The process of influencing the behavior of others and directing their efforts towards achieving the goals and

objectives of the organization" (Mahmoud Salman, 2010, p. 274).

3.3 Definition of Dawah work

The term "Dawah work" is a compound phrase consisting of two words: "work" and "Dawah" It is defined as "the exertion of all physical and mental energy by the missionary in conveying the Islamic message" (Hussein Majd, 1987, p. 7).

Accordingly, Dawah work involves exerting all efforts -physical or intellectual- through words or actions, to spread the teachings of the Islamic message.

4. The Leadership and The Leader

Undoubtedly, leading people is a significant trust and a great responsibility due to the diversity of their natures and the circumstances surrounding them. Therefore, a leader must adhere to several principles and foundations and possess a set of characteristics and skills to succeed in their leadership, convey their message, and fulfill their role.

4.1 Importance of Leadership and Its Principles

Leadership holds significant importance in steering, planning, directing, and achieving the desired goals of Dawah work. Leadership is based on principles that are the foundation and cornerstone of the success of Dawah efforts.

4.1.1 Importance of Leadership

Leadership has significant importance, which can be summarized in the following points:

A. Establishing Succession on Earth Allah Almighty said: **"And [mention, O Muhammad], when your Lord said to the angels, Indeed, I will make upon the earth a successive authority..."** (Surah

Al-Baqarah:30). This verse establishes the principle of appointing a leader and caliph who is to be listened to and obeyed, to unite the people and implement judgments. There is no disagreement about the necessity of this among the Ummah (Muslim community) or among the scholars (Muhammad, 1964, Vol. 1, p. 264).

B. The connecting link, represented by the force that flows to direct energies in a coordinated manner, ensures the success of Dawah work plans and their future visions.

C. Controlling the problems of Dawah work, devising the necessary plans to resolve them, settling disputes, and weighing differing opinions.

D. Strengthening the positive forces in Dawah work and minimizing the negative aspects as much as possible.

E. Strengthening the positive forces in missionary work and minimizing the negative aspects as much as possible.

F. A legal necessity and a social principle that must not be neglected or ignored under any circumstances, as it ensures the regulation of societal affairs, the establishment of justice, the maintenance of security, and the organization of life. It prevents chaos and conflicting opinions.

G. Coordinating and consolidating efforts, protecting Dawah work from division, achieving goals, and preventing it from falling into the abyss of disagreement. The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said: "...And it is not permissible for three people to be in a deserted land without appointing one of them as their leader..." (Ahmad, 2001, Vol. 11, p. 227).

4.1.2 Principles of Leadership

Islam has given special attention to leadership, considering it essential for any group with a specific goal. Upon reviewing several studies and writings in the field of leadership, most researchers have agreed

on a set of principles, the most important of which are:

A. Sincerity: One of the most fundamental principles, sincerity stems from the intention of the heart. It is the core of all actions and worship, and the measure of their acceptance or rejection.

A leader must prioritize sincerity and selflessness in both speech and action, in private and in public. As a bearer of a significant mission, the leader carries a great responsibility. A leader should aim to please Allah (SWT) through their efforts with individuals and communities. They must avoid showing off and seeking reputation, ensuring that their work is dedicated solely to Allah.

B. Justice: A fundamental principle of leadership. The clearest manifestation of justice is found in the words of Allah Almighty: **"...and when you judge between people to judge with justice..."** (Surah An-Nisa:58).

Justice is a primary requirement in Islam and a duty for leaders, rulers, and those in similar positions. A leader must pursue justice and reject any form of oppression, regardless of the reasons or justifications, to maintain the cohesion, unity, and solidarity of Dawah work.

C. Equality: Islam places great emphasis on the principle of equality, giving it considerable attention. There is no distinction between humans except in piety. Allah Almighty says: **"Indeed, the most noble of you in the sight of Allah is the most righteous of you. Indeed, Allah is Knowing and Aware"** (Surah Al-Hujurat:13), Therefore, those who assume leadership in the field of missionary work must embody this principle in their interactions with workers in the missionary field without discrimination or favoritism. This approach will instill in them the greatness of this principle and its

importance in the success of missionary work and the achievement of its goals.

D. Consultation (Shura): Allah Almighty has commanded His noble Messenger ﷺ in several places in the Holy Qur'an to engage in consultation as one of the most important principles of sound leadership. Allah says: **"..and consult them in the matter.."** (Surah Āl- 'Imrān:159), Consultation is a fundamental and essential principle in leadership. It is crucial for a leader to commit to consultation with scholars, knowledgeable individuals, and anyone capable of offering advice and guidance. Consultation (Shura) is one of the most important principles upon which successful missionary leadership is based. It establishes the process of participation in decision-making and prevents the leader from making unilateral decisions. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ firmly established this principle in many situations throughout his life.

E. Good Example (Role Model): The leader serves as the role model for the group they lead, setting the standard for others to follow. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ is the ultimate example to be emulated. Allah says: **"There has certainly been for you in the Messenger of Allah an excellent pattern..."** (Surah Al-Ahzab:21). Being a good example in Dawah work holds great importance in achieving the goals and objectives of Islamic dawah. The goodness in a nation is elevated by its virtuous members.

F. Moderation and Balance: Leadership in Islam is characterized by moderation, standing between the extremes of the purely scientific approach and the purely human relations approach. This is because the Islamic Ummah (community) is a community of moderation. Allah says: **"And thus We have made you a median [i.e., just] community..."** (Surah Al-Baqarah:143).

G. Humility: Is one of the most beloved qualities to Allah and is closest to people's

hearts. It is a great attribute and a noble principle. Allah commanded His Prophet ﷺ to be humble towards the believers, saying: “...**And lower your wing [i.e., show kindness] to the believers**” (Surah Al-Hijr:88).

Humility is a distinctive characteristic of Islamic leadership and a fundamental principle that leaders in missionary work must adhere to. They should avoid arrogance and pride, recognizing their role as callers to Allah and Islam.

H. Wisdom: Is essential and a key principle of leadership that a leader needs in many situations. It involves selecting the appropriate leadership style with knowledge, insight, precision, and skill.

Due to the importance and great status of wisdom in leadership and dawah, Allah bestowed it upon His Prophet ﷺ and commanded him to apply it in both speech and action. Allah says: “...**And Allah has revealed to you the Book and wisdom and has taught you that which you did not know. And ever has the favor of Allah upon you been great**” (Surah An-Nisa:113).

4.2 Elements and Theories of Leadership

The phenomenon of leadership has long captivated human interest. Leadership can be transferred from one person to another, remain with the same individual, or be shared by multiple people simultaneously. Leadership theories are a set of ideas and models aimed at understanding and analyzing how a leader influences and guides followers to achieve common goals.

4.2.1 Elements of Leadership

Leadership is based on three essential elements: (Tariq and Faisal, 2004, p. 40)

A. Having a purpose that motivates people. This involves establishing a clear and

compelling goal that inspires and drives people to take action.

B. Assembling a group of individuals who are committed to working together towards the common goal. This group forms the team or community that collaborates to achieve the vision.

C. (A Leader Who Shapes This into Practical Actions): Having a leader who can translate the goal into actionable steps, influence the group, and effectively guide them towards achieving the desired outcomes.

Narrated by Ibn Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Prophet ﷺ said: “**All of you are shepherds and each of you is responsible for his flock. The leader is a shepherd, and the man is a shepherd over his family, and the woman is a shepherd over her husband's house and children. So all of you are shepherds and each of you is responsible for his flock**” (Muhammad, 1993, Vol. 5, p. 1996).

4.2.2 Theories of Leadership

Leadership theories can be divided into several main categories, including:

A. Functional Leadership Theory: This theory focuses on the study of tasks and functions performed by leaders. Proponents of this theory are concerned with how leadership responsibilities and tasks are distributed.

Leadership functions include: direction, decision-making, planning, coordination. According to this theory, the leader's personality is centered on being a role model and exemplar (Muhammad Akram, 2000, p. 30).

B. Situational Leadership Theory: The core idea of this theory revolves around the concept of leadership in relation to leadership behavior in specific situations or general circumstances.

It is a theory that asserts that a leader who is suitable for leading in one phase, given

certain circumstances, may not be suitable for another phase or different circumstances (Tariq and Faisal, 2004, p. 113).

C. Motivational Leadership Theory:

This theory revolves around the issue of interaction and integration between all priorities, foundations, and key variables in leadership. These variables can be identified in the following units:

- The Leader: Their personality and activity within the group.
- The Followers: Their attitudes, problems, and needs.
- The Group: The type of group, its relationships, characteristics, and goals.
- The Situations: The nature of the work, working conditions, and the material factors of the situation.

This theory focuses on the extent of the leader's interaction with the followers and their mutual perception of each other. Thus, it is possible to identify "the leader, the situation, the followers, and the interaction between them" (Badria, Aisha, 1987, p. 110).

D. Trait Leadership Theory: This theory focuses on the leader in terms of their personality, traits, and characteristics. Through research, scholars have identified five types of leadership traits as follows: (Muhammad Akram, 2000, p. 32)

- Physical Traits: Such as height, build, and health.
- Cognitive Mental Traits: The leader's mental abilities, such as the ability to foresee, intelligence, and cultural knowledge.
- Social Traits: Such as the ability to interact effectively, gain the affection and trust of others.
- Emotional Traits: Including emotional maturity, self-confidence, among others.
- Formal Traits: Such as good appearance and general demeanor. The criteria for determining

leadership traits vary from one society to another.

E. Transitional Leadership Theory: The Transitional leader is characterized as a visionary and a mission-driven individual whose role is to guide those around them towards a significant and progressive change.

According to this theory, the leader has four main tasks: (Tariq and Faisal, 2004, pp. 108-110)

- Vision Identification: The leader articulates the dream, presenting it to followers as a vivid and attractive picture of the desired future.
- Communicating the Vision to Followers: An effective leader conveys the vision to followers in an emotional and clear manner, making them see it as vividly as they see their reality, thus getting excited, driven, and willing to make sacrifices for it.
- Implementing the Vision: An effective leader does not just explain the vision but lives it and relates every small or large event to the desired vision.
- Increasing Followers' Commitment to the Vision: The fourth task of an effective leader is to enhance followers' commitment to the vision. The leader uses various methods to instill this commitment, including encouragement and reminders, involving followers in shaping the vision and decision-making, and setting a good example.

F. Principle-Centered Leadership Theory: A principle-centered leader works to achieve justice, compassion, efficiency, and effectiveness. This leader also deepens the sense of noble meanings and purposes behind the work.

The principle-centered leader combines the achievement of the institution's goals with the individuals' goals and relies on

persuasion and consultation (Muhammad Akram, 2000, p. 37).

G. Inspirational Leadership Theory:

This theory asserts that great individuals emerge as leaders due to their extraordinary abilities and talents. These leaders are the ones who bring about change in collective life.

In Islamic history, there have been such inspirational leaders who operated based on Islamic principles. They considered both apparent reasons or material conditions and unseen reasons or spiritual and faith-based conditions. The result of moving according to these reasons was changes in the human conscience that led to significant transformations in human history. One of these figures is Umar ibn Abdul Aziz, who brought about positive changes in the Islamic society in a short period (Badria, Aisha, 1987, pp. 112-114).

4.3 Characteristics and Skills of the Leader and Their Role

Leadership requires a number of characteristics and skills in a leader; the individual who guides, influences, and directs people to achieve specific goals, ensuring the success of their leadership and mission.

4.3.1 Characteristics and Skills of the Leader

The effective leader possesses the following key characteristics and skills: (Muhammad Akram, 2000, p. 21)

A. Key Characteristics of an Effective Leader:

- **Inherent (Innate) Characteristics:** Intelligence, Courage, Generosity, Determination, Honesty, Humility, Optimism, Strength, Moderation, Integrity, Confidence, Loyalty.
- **Acquired Characteristics:** Faith, Knowledge, Self-control, Sense of

responsibility, Maturity, Boldness, Ambition.

- **Social Characteristics:** Kindness, Gentleness, Justice, Equality, Consultation (Shura), Participation, Forgiveness, Restraint, Acceptance of advice, good selection of assistance.

B. Key Skills of an Effective Leader:

- **Mental /Intellectual Skills:** Thinking, Planning, Creativity, Innovation, Visualization.
- **Social Skills:** Relationships, Communication, Listening, Motivation.
- **Technical/Specialized Skills:** Organization, Execution, Decision-Making, Problem-Solving.

4.3.1 The Role of the Leader

Dawah work cannot succeed or be organized without wise and effective leadership that seeks the interests of its followers by promoting good and noble qualities and preventing evil and vices, without favoritism, injustice, or neglect.

Therefore, Dawah work of all kinds requires an effective leader who guides it, and undertakes the planning, organization, and coordination among all categories of workers. This leadership shapes the Dawah work with its direction and imparts its distinctive character.

In general, it can be said that there are ten essential roles for a leader: (Nasser Makarem, 2009, pp. 37-110)

A. Decision making: Leaders are responsible for making critical decisions that affect the direction and success of their organization. This involves analyzing information, considering alternatives, and choosing the best course of action.

B. Programming and planning: Leaders must develop strategic plans and programs to achieve organizational goals. This includes setting objectives, determining the

necessary resources, and creating timelines for implementation.

C. Organization: Effective leaders organize resources, tasks, and people to ensure efficient and effective operations. This involves structuring the organization, delegating responsibilities, coordinating efforts.

D. Establishing, discipline, coordination: Leaders create and maintain a disciplined environment where team members follow rules and procedures. They also ensure coordination among various departments and teams to achieve common goals.

E. Creating motivation and drive: Leaders inspire and motivate their team members to perform at their best. This involves recognizing and addressing individual and team needs, providing incentives, and fostering a positive work environment.

F. Problem-solving addressing unexpected incidents: Leaders must be able to quickly and effectively address problems and unexpected challenges. This requires critical thinking, adaptability, and the ability to stay calm under pressure.

G. Evaluating, studying success and failure factors: Leaders regularly evaluate organizational performance to understand what works and what doesn't. This involves analyzing successes and failures to make informed decisions for future actions.

H. Collecting information and statistics: Leaders gather and analyze data to inform decision-making and strategic planning. This includes monitoring performance metrics, conducting research, and staying informed about industry trends.

I. Attracting suitable elements: Leaders are responsible for recruiting and retaining talented individuals who can contribute to the organization's success. This involves identifying skills and qualities needed, conducting interviews, and creating a supportive work environment.

J. The element of appreciation, encouragement, and reprimand: Leaders provide feedback to their team members to guide performance. This includes recognizing and rewarding achievements, encouraging continued effort, and addressing areas for improvement constructively."

5. The Effective leadership

5.1 The Leadership challenges

The issue of leadership is very complex and delicate, making it susceptible to problems and challenges. Some of the problems that leadership faces include:

A. The absence of planning and organization, and not benefiting from past experiences.

B. The lack of creative ideas and developmental visions, and the failure to adopt, develop, and benefit from them.

C. Encouraging a culture of individual work and competition instead of teamwork.

D. The prevalence of chaos and lack of discipline required for effective advocacy work.

E. The lack of a leader who possesses the knowledge and skills to build an effective team and the inability to bear responsibility.

F. Neglecting to carefully select team members and failing to utilize talents effectively.

G. The scarcity of qualified personnel and the shortage of trained individuals capable of effective advocacy work.

H. The challenges posed by cultural, social, political, and legal temptations and suspicions.

I. Autocracy in leadership, centralizing decision-making, and negatively impacting leadership effectiveness.

J. Internal conflicts and disputes among team members, which can lead to scattered efforts and reduced efficiency.

K. Weak organizational capabilities, with leaders lacking the personal talents and

organizational skills needed to maintain order, set rules and principles, leading to disorganized advocacy work and overlapping authorities, which results in growing problems and issues (Fathi, n.d., p. 72).

L. The lack of financial resources and funding, which can hinder advocacy work and limit its effectiveness.

M. Failure to set clear objectives for Dawah work and to direct efforts towards achieving them using all available means results in working haphazardly without progressing towards those goals in a gradual and organized manner.

5.2 The Prophetic Leadership School

Prophetic traditions emphasize the inevitability of leadership as a social necessity. The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said: “...**It is not permissible for three people to be in an open land without appointing one of them as their leader...**” (Ahmad, 2001, Vol. 11, p. 227). He also said: “**When three people set out on a journey, they should appoint one of them as their leader**” (Sulayman, 1995, Vol. 8, p. 99). The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) was an exemplary leader and role model for the Islamic nation, which believed in his message, adhered to his call, and sacrificed themselves and their wealth to spread his message.

The leadership of the Prophet ﷺ in appointing leaders and governors was extremely meticulous. He chose individuals who possessed upright character, extensive knowledge, and a high degree of competence and merit. Therefore, we find that the selection of leaders in the early days of Islam was based on integrity, capability, and honesty. Islamic leadership is founded on the principle of consultation (Shura).

The leadership abilities of the Prophet ﷺ were evident in various fields, including

the planning and organization of the Islamic call in both Meccan and Medinan societies. He succeeded in uniting the hearts of the Ansar (helpers) and the Muhajirun (migrants), and in establishing treaties and agreements with non-Muslims. His leadership style is also evident in his reception and hospitality towards Arab delegations, aimed at convincing and attracting them to Islam. His noble leadership is further exemplified by his stance during the Treaty of Hudaibiyyah, where he demonstrated patience, endurance, and leniency to prevent bloodshed.

The primary mission of the Prophet ﷺ was to select and prepare leaders in alignment with his compassionate and humane perspective, even in matters of war. Leadership is an extremely challenging task in our modern era, where all kinds of support and facilities are readily available to senior military leaders for preparing field commanders. Imagine the difficulty during the time of the Prophet ﷺ, when none of these aids and facilities existed. In the prophetic era, there was no established framework for preparing leaders of that time. Leadership was an innate tendency that emerged in some individuals, refined in the field, where competencies and the hidden potentials of men were discovered, each according to his ability and capacity (Zainab, 2015, p. 293).

The Prophet ﷺ was keen on leadership and selected the best men for leadership roles. His sole criterion for appointing leaders was competence and the willingness to perform the task. The lesson he left regarding the proper and correct selection of leaders is based on his noble hadith, which made this matter a trust in the hands of those making decisions and appointing leadership positions. He said: “**If any man appoints another man to a position of leadership over ten people while knowing that there is someone among them who is more competent than the**

one, he appointed, he has betrayed Allah, His Messenger, and the community of Muslims" (Jamaluddin, 1997, Vol. 4, p. 63).

Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) was the ultimate and exemplary model of a leader across all fields: political, military, social, economic, educational, judicial, scientific, practical, and in all aspects of life. He was the perfect example of a noble human being and the bearer of the eternal message.

He was the perfect model of a refined human being with an eternal message.

He left behind a second line of leaders whom he prepared in the best possible way, among them:

A. Abu Bakr (may Allah be pleased with him): His leadership was characterized by the caliphate, the preservation of the state, and obedience to Allah and His Messenger ﷺ. This obedience is exemplified in the preparation of Usama's army and the Wars of Apostasy. After the death of the Prophet ﷺ, tribes began racing towards apostasy, and the situation nearly spiraled out of control. Internal problems started emerging, putting the city of Medina, the capital of the Islamic state, at risk of fragmentation. The general trend in Medina was to secure the internal front at the expense of external expansion. The people of consultation urged Abu Bakr to divert from preparing Usama's army to face the rebellion and secure Medina. Some advised that the expedition remain in Medina after the Prophet's ﷺ death, including Usama, while others suggested appointing an older and more experienced leader in the arts of war (Ibrahim Ahmad, 2019, p. 194).

How Did Abu Bakr Respond? He said, "By Allah, I will not undo a knot tied by the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, even if birds snatch us away and beasts surround Medina, and even if dogs drag the feet of the mothers of the believers, I will still dispatch Usama's army" (Imad al-Din, 1997, Vol. 9, p. 421).

Piety, altruism, kindness, caution, consultation, preparedness, mobilization, courage, boldness, not judging people based on suspicions, and generosity in dealing with others are all elements that distinguished Abu Bakr's leadership theory from others.

These great leadership qualities were embodied in Abu Bakr al-Siddiq's advice to Usama bin Zayd as he went to battle. He said: "O people, stop and listen to my ten commandments, which you must heed: Do not betray, do not steal from the spoils, do not act treacherously, do not mutilate the dead, do not kill a child, an elderly person, or a woman. Do not cut down or burn palm trees, do not cut down fruit-bearing trees, and do not slaughter sheep, cows, or camels except for food" (Muhammad, 1967, Vol. 3, pp. 226-227).

B. Umar ibn al-Khattab (may Allah be pleased with him):

The standard from which Umar ibn al-Khattab led the state was justice. He inaugurated a new era in the state, established a government, organized administrative offices, and set up the principles of judiciary and administration. He created a treasury, connected the parts of the state through a postal system, protected its borders with stationed guards, and made the pilgrimage season an occasion for public review, accountability, and gathering public opinion from various parts of the state (Abbas Mahmoud, 1998, p. 86).

He would appoint a leader to a position of authority, delegating to him all the powers of the caliph, equipping him with the tools of governance: authority, responsibility, and information. He provided everything required for the function of leadership: simplified administrative procedures, a distinguished organizational structure, clear laws and regulations, and above all, he granted the necessary authorization to manage financial affairs to ensure the development of the land.

He also monitored them with strict financial controls. This is how he cultivated leaders. For Umar ibn al-Khattab, the standard of competence was the quality of service (Ibrahim Ahmad, 2019, pp. 200-201).

Umar's leadership was based on a theory whose philosophy was founded on justice, truth, moderation, and balance. His goal was to build the individual before establishing systems of governance.

5.3 The Methodology of Leadership Preparation and Its Role in Achieving the Objectives in Dawah Work

5.3.1 The Methodology of Leadership Preparation

The features and pathways for preparing leaders are defined as follows: (Muhammad Akram, 2000, p. 74)

A. Leadership preparation and development should be an integral part of the organization's strategy: This ensures that leadership development is integrated into the core planning and objectives of the organization, aligning leadership training with long-term goals.

B. Establish schools and training centers for leaders: Creating dedicated institutions for leadership education and training provides a structured environment for developing the necessary skills and knowledge.

C. Provide the necessary leadership methods: Offering well-designed leadership courses and materials helps in equipping potential leaders with theoretical and practical insights into effective leadership.

D. Encourage dialogue and discussion through leadership conferences specifically held for this purpose: Organizing leadership conferences fosters an environment for exchanging ideas,

sharing experiences, and discussing challenges, which enhances learning and development.

E. Provide opportunities for participation in leadership positions, taking on responsibilities, and practically experiencing them: Hands-on experience in leadership roles allows individuals to apply their knowledge, learn from real-world challenges, and build confidence in their leadership abilities.

F. Adopt an authentic approach to the issue of completely transferring leadership to the next generation: Ensuring a structured and well-thought-out process for leadership succession guarantees continuity and stability within the organization.

G. Allow for the planning of integrating promising new elements into leadership: Strategically incorporating new and promising talents into leadership roles ensures that the organization remains dynamic and innovative.

H. Be patient with young leaders, as daily challenges and the theory of accumulation will complete their development: Recognizing that leadership development is a gradual process and supporting young leaders through their challenges and learning experiences ensures their growth and maturity as effective leaders.

5.3.2 The Role of Leadership in Achieving the Objectives in Dawah Work

The role of leadership in achieving the objectives of Dawah work is essential and extremely important, as leadership significantly influences the success of advocacy efforts and the achievement of desired goals, including:

A. Setting Vision and Goals:

- Establishing a Clear Vision: Leadership in Dawah work should define a clear and specific vision for

what it seeks to achieve, directing efforts towards common goals.

- **Setting Measurable Goals:** Establishing measurable and evaluable goals helps in tracking progress and ensuring the desired outcomes are achieved.

B. Planning and Organization:

- **Strategic Planning:** Developing long-term strategic plans to guide Dawah work towards the defined goals.
- **Organizing and Coordinating:** Effectively organizing those involved in a Dawah work and distributing tasks ensures smooth and efficient operations.

C. Motivation and Encouragement:

- **Motivating the Team:** A successful leader works to motivate team members and encourage hard work and perseverance.
- **Providing Moral Support:** Offering psychological and moral support to those involved in Dawah work enhances their morale and increases their commitment.

D. Capacity Building:

- **Training and Development:** Providing training programs to develop the skills of the Dawah team members and increase their efficiency.
- **Empowering the Team:** Granting the team the necessary authority to make decisions and take initiatives, enhancing their sense of responsibility and ownership.

E. Effective Communication:

- **Continuous Communication:** Maintaining open and sustainable communication channels between the leader and team members to enhance collaboration and idea exchange.

- **Listening to Ideas and Suggestions:** Listening to the opinions and ideas of team members and involving them in decision-making.

F. Change Management:

- **Flexibility in Handling Challenges:** The ability to adapt to changing circumstances and new challenges and manage change effectively.
- **Leading Transformation:** Guiding the team towards the required changes to achieve Dawah goals more effectively.

G. Evaluation and Follow-up:

- **Performance Evaluation:** Regularly evaluating advocacy work performance to identify strengths and weaknesses and take corrective actions.
- **Providing Feedback:** Offering constructive feedback to team members to improve their performance and develop their skills.

H. Building Relationships and Partnerships:

- **Building Community Relations:** Establishing strong relationships with the local community and stakeholders to support Dawah work.
- **Collaborating with Other Institutions:** Collaborating with religious, educational, and community institutions to enhance Dawah efforts and expand their impact.

I. Innovation and Creativity:

- **Encouraging Innovation:** Encouraging the team to think creatively and innovate new methods in Dawah work.
- **Developing Strategies:** Developing new and innovative strategies to achieve Dawah goals effectively.

J. Commitment to Values and Principles:

- Being a Good Role Model: The advocacy leader should be a good role model for team members and the community, enhancing the credibility of the Dawah.
- Commitment to Ethical Values: Adhering to principles and ethical values in all Dawah work to ensure the integrity of the message.

By effectively implementing these roles, leadership in advocacy work can significantly contribute to achieving Dawah goals and building a more cohesive community committed to Islamic values and principles.

6. CONCLUSION

Through our study of the leadership challenge in Dawah work, we have reached several conclusions as follows:

- ✓ Leadership is indeed a real challenge for Dawah work, referring to the process of influencing others' behavior and directing their efforts towards achieving the organization's goals and objectives.
- ✓ Leadership is of great importance in managing the problems of advocacy work, formulating necessary plans to solve them, resolving conflicts, coordinating and consolidating efforts, protecting Dawah work from fragmentation, and achieving objectives.
- ✓ Effective leadership requires a range of characteristics and skills in a leader, including innate traits, acquired qualities, social attributes, intellectual skills, social skills, and technical skills.
- ✓ Some of the problems facing leadership include the absence of

planning and organization, a shortage of qualified personnel, autocratic decision-making without consultation, and internal conflicts and disputes among members of the Dawah team.

- ✓ The role of leadership in achieving the objectives of Dawah work is fundamental and highly important, as leadership significantly impacts the success of Dawah activities and the attainment of desired goals and aspirations.

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